Tile Siege Game Manual

Overview

Tile Siege is a 2-player strategy game about 2 kingdoms vying for control of the region. As their rulers, it is the players' responsibility to command their army of knights to usurp control of their rival, or annihilate them altogether.

This game is played in 2 phases by first constructing the map to play on, then competing on the new map. This manual serves as a detailed guide for both phases separately. While its length may seem overwhelming, we intend for this guide to be unnecessary after a game or two.

There is a glossary on the last page.

Components

- 6 knights
- 2 Coin Counters (including a wheel and pointer)
- 2 Castles
- 2 Flags
- 54 Action Cards (48 unique)
- 38 Tiles
    - 1 Centerpiece
    - 7 four-ways
      8 three-ways
    - 8 bent two-ways
    - 8 straight two-ways
    - 4 dead-ends
    - 2 Home Bases

Setup

- Remove the Centerpiece and Home Base tiles (marked by a dot on their reverses) from the tile supply, then shuffle all the remaining tiles. Place these tiles in a stack face-down.
    - For the intended experience, randomly remove 5 tiles from play.
    - For a shorter experience, remove 2 dead-end tiles and an additional 15 randomly selected tiles from play.



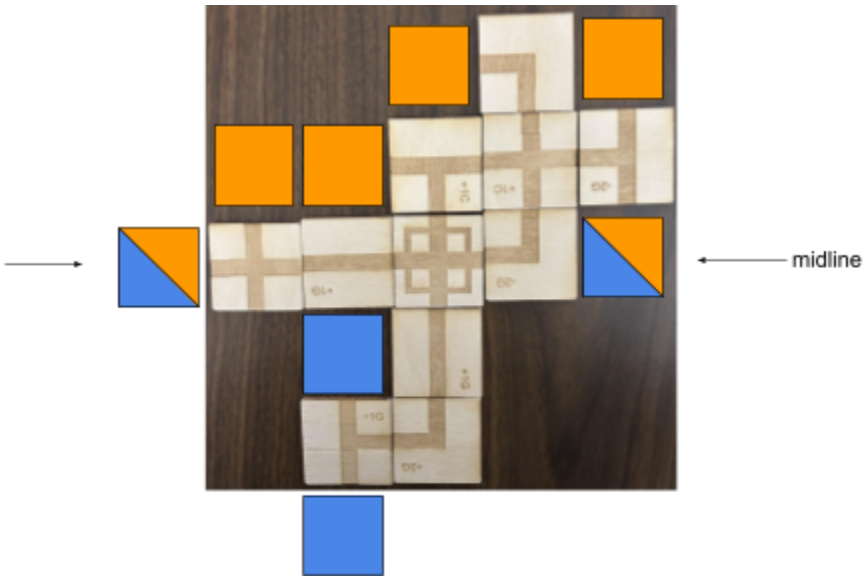
Left: Centerpiece tile
Right: Home Base tile

- Remove the two “Starter Move” and “Starter Attack” cards from the deck, and give them to each player. Shuffle all the remaining cards and place face-down within reach of both players.
- Give each player their three colored knights. Set each of their health to 5.
- Assemble each colored Coin Counter and give them to the correct players. Set each value to 5.
- Give each player their colored flag and castle. Place the flag in the appropriate slot in the castle. Put these aside for now.
- Place the Centerpiece tile in the center of the play area. Give each player one Home Base tile. Set these aside for now.
- Determine the first active player.

Phase 1: Road to War

Overview

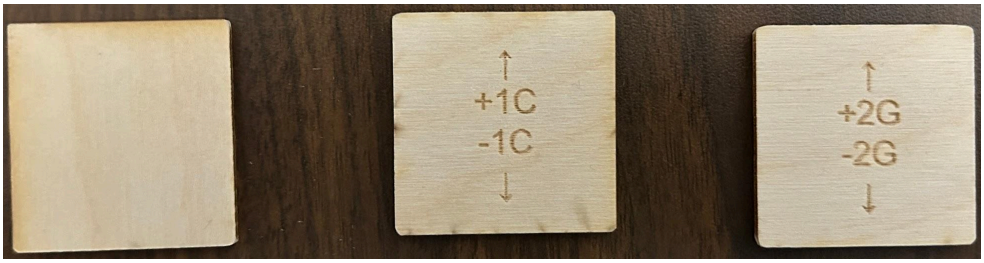
- Phase 1 consists of a tile draft in order to build the board.
- Some tiles grant bonuses for being selected in the draft. These bonuses can be positive or negative, depending on which side of the board the tile is going to be played on.
- A particular player's "side of the board" includes any space on their side of the marked center tile **and** any spaces horizontally aligned with the center tile. In other words, anywhere but "north" (from that player's perspective) of the center tile.



Assuming Blue is the bottom player, this diagram shows locations that a tile is placeable at, depending on the active player. Note that it includes everywhere below ("south" of) the Centerline, plus the horizontal axis aligned with it.

Drafting

- Each round starts by drawing 3 tiles face-down from the tile supply.

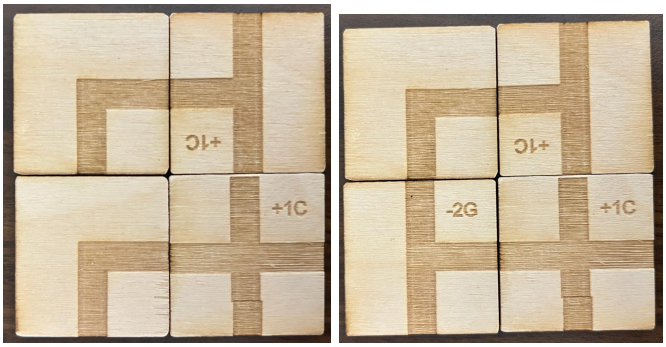


A face-down 3-tile draft

- The active player selects 1 tile among the 3. The other player selects 1 among the remaining 2.
- The third tile is discarded face-down to a separate pile.

Placing a Tile

- The active player places their chosen tile to **their own** side of the board (i.e."south" of the Centerpiece) or along the midline, horizontally aligned with the Centerpiece.
- The other player then places their chosen tile to the **active player's** side of the board (i.e. "north" of the Centerpiece) or along the midline.
- Placed tiles must extend an existing road system by connecting its own roads with those of all adjacent roads. Thus, "artificial" dead ends cannot be created.

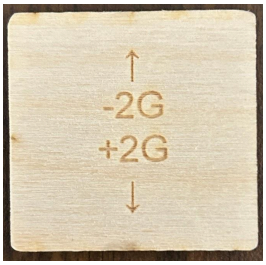


Left: placing the bottom-right tile creates an artificial dead-end by terminating the road of the top-left tile. This is forbidden.
Right: placing the bottom-left tile extends the existing road system by connecting to both its adjacent roads. This is legal.

- If the tile cannot legally be played to the correct side of the board, it must be played to the opposite side. The alternative bonus on the tile's reverse is then applied as well.
- If the tile cannot be played anywhere without creating an artificial dead-end, it is permitted to create an artificial dead-end.
- If the tile cannot be played anywhere, discard it and continue with normal play.

Applying Tile Bonuses

- The backs of some tiles display positive and negative values associated with directions.
- If the player that claimed this tile is the active player (i.e. playing to their own side), apply the bottom bonus.
- If the player that claimed this tile is not the active player (i.e. playing to the opponent's side), apply the top bonus.



If this tile is being played to the player's opponent's side, pay 2 gold.
If this tile is being played to the player's own side, gain 2 gold.

- If the bonus is a cost (i.e. a negative value), the player applying this bonus **must pay this cost** in order to play this tile.
    - If this player is unable to play any available tiles due to their costs, select a tile, pay as much of the cost as possible, then waive the rest.
- If the bonus is a positive value and the player applying this bonus cannot increase the relevant resource any further, no benefit is gained.

Continuing

- After both players have placed their tiles, the active player switches, and the draft is repeated with 3 new face-down tiles.
- Once all of the original tiles have been exhausted, continue the draft with the discard pile (there should be 10 tiles here in a standard game, or 6 in a shortened one). Instead of dealing 3 tiles per draft, only deal 2.
- At the end of a complete draft, players should be left with a full map, an empty tile supply, and some number of initial cards and gold.
- Players place their Home Base tiles anywhere on their side of the Centerline or along the midline. The player with the most gold chooses first.
    - The same rules about placing tiles above apply to the Home Base tiles. If it is somehow impossible to place a Home Base tile anywhere on the board, replace a currently-placed tile with the Home Base tile.
- Place each player's respective castle and flag on their Home Base tiles.
- Place 1 of each player's knights on their respective Home Bases. Place another 1 of each player's knights on the Centerpiece.
- Finally, players may choose where their last knight starts. It must start at a terminus (exterior tile with only one outbound road) on that player's side of the board.
    - If no valid termini exist, this knight is placed at the appropriate Home Base.

Phase 2: Laying Siege

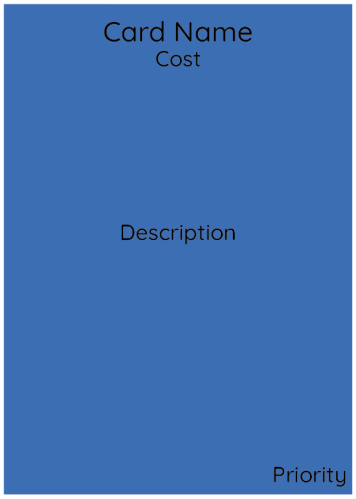
Overview

- Players take turns playing cards from their hands and performing the appropriate actions to *all* of their knights.
- Cards cost Gold (g) to play.
- Some tiles display positive or negative resource values the player must gain/pay respectively.
- Damage done to knights in combat is recorded on their spinning bodies by rotating their helmets to reveal the correct health value. If health is reduced below 1, that knight **dies** and is removed from play.
- Players are attempting to capture their opponent's flag and return it to their own Home Base.
- The game ends when a flag is successfully carried to the opposing castle, or if a player is left with no knights remaining.

Taking Turns

- Both players select a card from their hand that they wish to play.
- Selected cards are placed face-down, and then simultaneously revealed.
- Cards are resolved in Priority order (see "Playing Cards"). Once both players have finished resolving their cards, both cards are discarded.
    - With the exception of "Starter Move" and "Starter Attack", which are instead returned to the hand.
- Repeat this process until the end of the game.

Playing Cards



- All cards have a name, effect description, cost in gold (g) or health (hp), and priority.
- The cost **must** be paid in order to play a card. If the cost cannot be paid, the card may not be played.
- Costs paid in gold, ticks down your gold counter. Costs paid in health may be taken from any of your monsters in any distributed manner and ticks down the chosen monster counters.

- After paying for the cost, apply the effect listed on the card. Unless stated otherwise, the effect is applied to **all knights simultaneously.**
- Since cards are revealed simultaneously, the Priority determines the order of player execution. Cards effects are applied in order of decreasing Priority, i.e. largest number to smallest.
- If the Priority of two cards are equal the tie is won by the player with more gold after paying for the cost.
- If players have the same amount of gold, attacks happen first then movement. If they are both attacks, then they happen simultaneously..
- In the case that both players selected movement cards with equal Priority, movement alternates per space. See "Movement" below.
- Cards that have the word "**single"** may only be applied to a single one of your knights.
- There is a **maximum hand size of 6, including starter cards**. You may not draw above this limit.
- Decimal values are rounded down to the nearest whole number. EX: 2.5 → 2

Movement

- Movement may only occur between adjacent tiles connected by a road, unless otherwise stated.
- Unless otherwise stated, movement actions apply to all of a player's knights simultaneously.
- Regardless of their locations on the map, all of a player's knights must attempt to follow the same *move pattern*.
    - For example, if the chosen 2-space move pattern was "up then left," all of the player's knights must attempt to move up, then they must all attempt to move left. If a knight fails to move up, it will only move left.
- If two played movement cards have tied Priority, players will take turns (starting with the player with the highest total gold) making 1-space move patterns.

Movement Turn Order
With Same Priority

Orange: 3g	Blue: 4g
Played: Move 3	Played: Move 2

Turn Order:
Blue
Orange
Blue
Orange
Orange

Example move sequence. Each "turn" listed consists of a 1-space move pattern.

Bonus Tiles

- Much like in Phase 1, some tiles list positive or negative bonuses.
- When a knight enters a tile, that player is unconditionally subject to that bonus.
- If the bonus is a cost (i.e. the value is negative), knights must pay the cost to pass through this tile. If they are unable to afford the listed cost, pay everything possible and then deal the remainder as damage to that knight.
- If the bonus value is positive, gain the amount of the specified resource. If the player is already at the max of that resource, no benefit is gained.

Combat

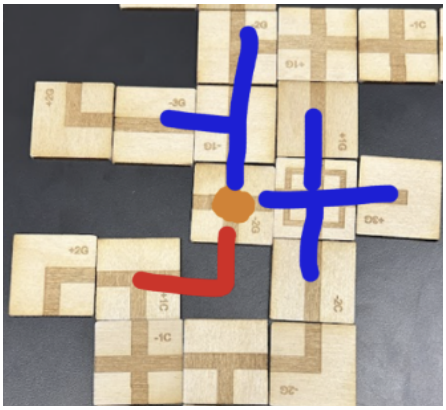
- Cards that involve attacking still resolve in normal Priority order.
- Unless otherwise stated, each knight's attack can only target a single other knight. Players must declare their target when attacking.



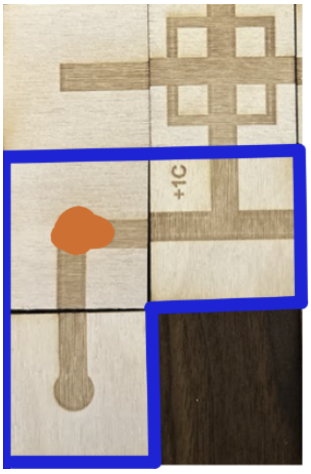
If Blue was attacking, they could only target one of Orange's knights.
If Orange was attacking, both of their knights could target the Blue knight.

- Damage is done at the end of priority, so if two players play an attack with the same priority they both deal damage, regardless of if their pawns may die.

- Combat cards routinely involve three keywords:
    - Damage X: your attacks will deal X damage.
    - Block X: for this round, your knights have +X "temporary" health. Temporary health gets removed first, and if temporary health was removed in any given hit, that specific hit is considered "weakened". Temporary health does not persist through multiple hits. Weakened attacks do that apply their special effects.
    - Special effects get applied at the end of
    - Range X: attacks can reach up to X tiles away from the attacking knight, following roads. The range does not need to be in a straight line, as long as the path is connected by roads.



If the orange dot is a pawn that's attacking with a range of 2, the blue lines traversing from the orange pawn represent its range, while the red line represents an illegal move, as there is no tile or road to connect the attack.



If the pawn is attacking with a range of 1, the blue outlines represent the tiles it can attack. The top-left is out of range since it can't be reached in 1 step via roads.

Capturing the Flag

- If a knight reaches their opponent's Home Base tile, transfer the opponent's flag from their castle to the player's knight.
- Until this knight dies, the flag is carried with them through all of their movement.
- If the knight dies, the flag is dropped. It cannot be moved or returned to the opponent's base. Only another of the player's knights may collect it and continue their journey home.
- **Cards affecting a single knight may not affect a flagbearing knight.**

Ending the Game

- If a knight is able to bring an opponent's flag back to their own Home Base tile, the game ends and this player wins.
- Alternatively, if all of a player's knights die, that player loses.

Glossary

Tiles and the Map

- **Centerpiece:** the unique four-way tile with a box around it. Has a dot on its reverse.
- **Drafting Bonus:** positive and negative values shown on the reverse of some tiles, applied to the player that claims and plays this tile. The bottom bonus is applied if it is being played to their side (since the arrow is pointing toward themselves), and the inverse if played to the opponents side (arrow points away).
- **Home Base:** the two unique dead-end tiles ending with a dot. Have dots on their reverses.
- **Midline:** the horizontal line across the board that intersects the Centerpiece. It is considered "owned" by both players.
- **North, East, South, West:** directions relative to Centerpiece *and* the player's perspective. One player's north is the other player's south.
- **Side of the Board:** Region of the board including the midline *and* south of the board. In other words, everywhere but north.
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Cards

- **Block:** reduce damage taken this turn by the listed number. Block is lost at the end of the turn.
- **Cost:** cost in gold or health that must be paid in order to play a card. If the cost cannot be paid, the card cannot be played.
- **Damage:** deal this listed amount of damage to a valid target. If a knight takes more damage than it has health to spare, it dies and is removed from play.
- **Flagbearer:** the knight actively carrying a flag.
- **Move:** move all owned knights in a move pattern of the listed length. If an attempted move fails, continue with the next move in the pattern. If both players played move cards, regardless of priority resolution, steps are taken in alternation. The higher priority player goes first, then the other player, then back and forth until a player has exhausted all of their 1-step moves. Then the other player may finish all of their moves in succession.
- **Move Pattern:** a sequence of directions that all owned knights must attempt to follow during a movement turn. For example, a "move 2" card action could result in a move pattern of "north, then east." All knights must then attempt to move north, then attempt to move east.
- **Priority:** the order of card resolution, listed in the bottom right of each card. Higher priority goes first. In the case of equal card priority, the player with more gold goes first. In the case of equal gold, the player with the higher-cost card goes first. If still tied, break with rock-paper-scissors.
- **Range:** the maximum distance at which knights may successfully land an attack. This distance follows roads. For example, a "range 2" attack card action allows knights to successfully hit any opponent knights that are 0, 1, or 2 moves away from them.
- **Single:** keyword indicating that it only applies to a single knight, as opposed to all of them. Cards with this keyword *cannot* be applied to flagbearers.